



Slovakia



Painted houses

Traditional log houses in the village of Čičmany in northern Slovakia have been preserved for their unusual geometric decorations. The patterns were originally painted in mud and lime by local women.



Towering peaks

The Tatra Mountains mark Slovakia's border with Poland. The sharp peaks and lakes are the habitat of lynx, chamois (alpine goats), marmots, and eagles.

Easter eggs

Decorating eggs is an Easter tradition in Slovakia. They can be dyed or hand-painted like the ones here.



The fujara is held upright while played.

0 50 km
0 50 miles
(approximate scale)



Playing the fujara
Originally played by Slovakian shepherds, the fujara flute can now be heard at local festivals.

The open flower petals curve backward.

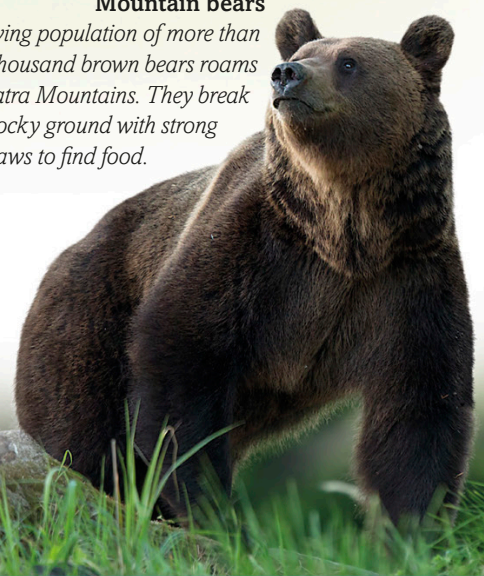


Wild blooms

The Turk's cap lily can grow to a height of 6 ft (1.8 m), with each stem holding up to 50 bowl-shaped flowers. These flowers grow wild on the slopes of the Carpathian Mountains.

Mountain bears

A growing population of more than a thousand brown bears roams the Tatra Mountains. They break up rocky ground with strong claws to find food.



- 📏 18,933 sq miles (49,035 sq km)
- 👤 5.4 million
- ★ Bratislava
- 🗣️ Slovak, Hungarian (Magyar), Czech

Slovakia became an **independent nation** in **1993**. Its **mountainous landscape** is dotted with **historic castles**. The **capital** city of **Bratislava** has a well-preserved **Old Town**.